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An Auto Company Zips Along the Fast Lane with FOSS

Carnation Auto, a multi-brand auto sales and service company, has grown phenomenally after opting for an open source enterprise platform.

*S*tarted in March 2009, Carnation Auto—a multi-brand automobile sales and services network set up by the former MD of Maruti Suzuki, Jagdish Khattar—offers car owners a wide array of services covering servicing, mechanical repairs, body repairs, accessories, insurance, pre-owned cars, car customisation solutions, etc. From rectifying scratches and bumps, to transforming off-the-assembly-line cars into one-of-a-kind attention-grabbers with accessories, Carnation has grown to 15 hubs across 10 cities, with more than 700 employees—all in a matter of nine months.

This accelerated growth wouldn't have been possible without open source technology. The firm adopted Red Hat Enterprise Linux Advanced Platform to run its business critical SAP ERP suite. The open source platform additionally helped it achieve integrated virtualisation on the HP ProLiant BL460c G6 server.

“When we started operations in 2009, we wanted to offer the customer a wide array of six to seven services, including mechanical servicing, body and paint work, CNG/LPG retro fittings, customisation, accessories, financing and insurance. To ensure a